If the king remains here next summer I intend trying to hire a very pretty orchard with a grove of large trees in it to encamp in during the hot months. This place belongs to the government and the custom is that in the spring the produce of the season is let out to the highest bidder; the fruit of this orchard may yield about six or eight pounds Str and I mean either to take it and have the amount charged to me on account of my pay or allowances and then I should have to relet the fruit or perhaps if the King or his minister if they are liberal, the one or the other may make me a present of the amount. I was in town last year until the end of July and fell ill accordingly.

Besides my monthly translations from the European newspapers I am now employed in making an abridged translation of a gazeteer. I do not know whether the King will have patience until I have done it or not as I am often set upon other work before I have finished that which I have in hand.

[EDWARD BURGESS TO GEORGE BURGESS] *Tehran, October 24, 1850*

I do not know whether you are aware that Charles left an illegitimate family in Persia, this consisted of the mother and two children a boy and a girl, the boy died in the spring of '41 of measles or rather diarrhea consequent on that disease. This family I have had for many years to support. The mother is a most respectable woman. Do not start; recollect that these sort of connections are looked upon in the East as a species of marriage. I should not have mentioned this affair at all but our niece Mary the girl above mentioned is now remarkably well married. Last spring the mother wrote to me from Tabreez asking my permission to allow Mary to marry a certain Ferramurz Khan, a major in the army and a man well to do in the world. Nargis (the mother) was affraid that I would not consent because this same Ferramurz Khan is a bigotted Roman Catholic. I wrote to Stevens our Consul at Tabreez (Or his brother George Stevens I forget which or both perhaps) where the family were to enquire, and be quite sure that the mother was not forcing the girl to marry a man twice her age, whom she might dislike, because he had a little money and rank. I also wrote, that as I had supported the family respectably so far, with God's help I would do so still, and by no means have the little girl forced into a match she did not like "as to Ferramurz Khan I know no harm about him except that he is a bigotted catholic, one who would burn us poor heretics without mercy if he could catch us, but as he is not likely to catch me, and if he did he is still less likely to burn his wife's uncle and as Mary is a catholic too, if she likes him I see no harm in the match" this is an extract from my letter as near as I can recollect it, and now I send you George Stevens' answer. I had written to him not to give my letter consenting to the match until he was thoroughly satisfied

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